A. Fill in the blanks using the words given in the box to complete the summary of the poem:

King Richard the Second, had surrendered to his (a)_____ cousin, Bolingbroke. He experienced deep distress at the horror of his circumstances. In that desperate situation, he speaks of (b)_____, (c)_____, (d)_____ and other things connected with death. He spoke of how people leave nothing behind and can call nothing their own, except for the small patch of (e)_____, where they will be buried. King Richard yielded to dejection and talked of all the different ways in which defeated kings suffer how some had been deposed, (f)_____ in war, (g)_____ by their wives and so forth. He attributed this loss of lives to (h)_____, whom he personified as the jester who watches over the shoulder of every ruler, who mocks kings by allowing them to think their human flesh, was like (i)_____ brass. However, Death penetrates through the castle walls, silently and unnoticed like a sharp (j)_____, thus bidding (k)_____ to him and all his pride forever. Finally, Richard appealed to his soldiers not to mock his mere flesh and blood by showing (l) _____ and respect to him. He added that he too needed bread to live, felt want, tasted (m)_____ and needed (n)_____. He concluded thus, urging his men not to call him a (o)_____ as he was only human, just like the rest of them.

barren-earth	**friends**	**graves**	**slain**
rebellious	**poisoned**	**worms**	**grief**
impregnable	**epitaphs**	**death**	**farewell**
reverence	**king**	**pin**	

B. The words used by Shakespeare find a place in present day conversations also. Here are a few examples of how these poetic, standardized English words could be used by common people in their regular speech.

a. Fill in the blanks with appropriate words from the box and complete the statements suitably:

bequeath	**antics**	**monarchise**
impregnable	**hollow**	

1. Shravan never keeps his promises. His friends know that his words are _____.
2. The spectators died laughing at the _____ of the clown.
3. The business woman wished to _____ all her riches to an orphanage, after her death.
4. The fortress was _____ and could not be conquered by the enemies.
5. Alexander the Great, wished to conquer many lands and _____ the entire world.

DO YOU KNOW?

Shakespeare wrote about 37 plays, which are broadly categorized under three heads, namely tragedies, comedies and histories.

The historic play '*Richard II*' is the only play written entirely in verse.

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